Frances LeMond

Data Documentation

Dataset Source:
Department of the United States Agriculture, “SNAP Data System”

Data Collectors:
Census Bureau and Bureau of Economic Analysis (Economic Research Service, ERS), these two groups also provide the updates for this data.
ERS link:
https://www.ers.usda.gov/topics/food-nutrition-assistance/food-assistance-data-collaborative-research-programs/national-data-sets/#policy

Context and Content:
This data was collected by many sources but mostly, the sampling content is from the Census Bureau running interviews with the general populous. Two vital groups for this data collection were the Small Area Income & Poverty Estimates program of the U.S. Census Bureau and the Food and Nutrition Services Administration.

Data Size: 10,312 KB

Permissions:
Freely available for public use, found at URL:
https://www.ers.usda.gov/data-products/supplemental-nutrition-assistance-program-snap-data-system/

Recommended Citation:
Economic Research Service (ERS) U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA). Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) Data System
http://www.ers.usda.gov/data-products/supplemental-nutrition-assistance-program-(snap)-data-system.aspx

Description:
I, Frances LeMond, have edited the data set and adapted it for academic purposes. The cleaned data set includes both the County and State Sheets from the Original Excel file. I have replaced the Variable Names of the original dataset to descriptive names and reduced the variables to the ones listed below in the Data Dictionary.

The edited dataset contains 39 Variables for County data and 38 variables for State (all of the variables of county data but without the urban/rural classification). There are 3197 observations/rows in the county data, this sheet does not include the summary statistic rows of the original dataset. The state dataset has 51 observations, all states and the District of Columbia.

I did not edit out null codes listed after the data dictionary.

Data Dictionary:

- ★ County Name: (County Sheet Only): Character
    - Lists the county name
- ★ Urban (County Sheet Only): 1 or 0
    - 1 for true, county is urban (defined by the BEA)
    - 0 for false, county is not urban
- ★ State (State Sheet Only): Character
    - Lists the state being observed
- ★ Total Population in XXXX: Numeric
    - Total population of the county or state in year XXXX
- ★ SNAP Participants in XXXX: Numeric
    - SNAP participant count for county or state in year XXXX
- ★ Annual Funding in XXXX: Numeric
    - Annual Funding in US$ in the thousands
- ★ Population in Poverty XXXX: Numeric
    - Population living below the poverty line in year XXXX

The original data set has server codes for null values:

- 9992: Data not available for a county
- 9993: Computed variable in which a value for the calculation is missing
- 9994: Data not available from U.S. Census
- 9995: Data not defined for years prior to that year (Program most likely didn't exist yet)
- 9996: Data missing due to BEA or Census suppression
- 9997: Data not available for that year
- 9998: Actual Value less than 50
- 9999: Data not available for other reasons than those listed above.

<u>CSV of Cleaned Data</u>: "Cleaned County Data.csv" & "Cleaned State Data.csv"